Kanban Board Design

Design a board that shows how work really flows: columns, WIP limits, exit policies and classes of service.

Manage Flow · Visualise the Workflow · Limit WIP · Make Policies Explicit

TEAM _____

DATE _____

1 Workflow Columns

LEFT TO RIGHT · ONE COLUMN PER REAL STATE OR QUEUE

COLUMN 1 *e.g. Options*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

Done when (exit policy):

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

COLUMN 2 *e.g. Ready*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

Done when (exit policy):

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

COLUMN 3 *e.g. Building*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

Done when (exit policy):

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

COLUMN 4 *e.g. Waiting for review*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

Done when (exit policy):

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

COLUMN 5 *e.g. Testing*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

Done when (exit policy):

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

COLUMN 6 *e.g. Ready to release*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

Done when (exit policy):

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

COLUMN 7 *Done*

Name: _____

WIP limit: _____

Done when (exit policy):

_____

_____

_____

☐ Active ☐ Queue

2 Classes of Service

HOW WE TREAT DIFFERENT KINDS OF WORK

CLASS	WHEN TO USE IT	OUR POLICY	LIMIT
Expedite	*Urgent, high cost of delay now*		
Fixed date	*Value drops after a date*		
Standard	*Most work, in priority order*		
Intangible	*Improvement, tech debt*		

3 Board Policies

WRITE THEM ON THE BOARD

We pull work when: _____

Blocked items are marked by: _____

Replenishment: when & who: _____

We walk the board at: _____

Definition of Done lives at: _____

Policies reviewed every: _____

4 Cards & Swimlanes

Each card shows:

☐ Title ☐ Owner ☐ Age (days)

☐ Blocked flag ☐ Class of service ☐ Due date

Swimlanes (if any): _____

5 Flow Metrics to Watch

LEARN, DON'T JUDGE

☐ WIP *items in progress*

☐ Cycle time *start to done, in days*

☐ Blocked time *days items spend blocked*

☐ Throughput *items done per week*

☐ Work item age *how long open items have run*

☐ Flow efficiency *active time / total time*

"Where does work wait, and is that visible on our board?"

"What would happen if we lowered this WIP limit by one?"

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